

DANIEL VLAD

DEVSECOPS ENGINEER / CLOUD SOLUTIONS ARCHITECT

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I am an experienced DevOps Engineer & Cloud Solution Architect specializing in Azure, with a strong background in consulting and customer support. I am committed to building strong customer relationships, delivering impactful solutions, and driving customer success through collaboration and innovation.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

DevSecOps Engineer

05/2024 – Present

Roland Berger · Munich, Germany

- Architected and delivered a zero-standing-privilege, self-service VM provisioning platform (Trusted Compute Instances) across a 300+ subscription Azure tenant – just-in-time PIM role assignment, an ABAC-fenced two-identity security model, and capability-based entitlement checks that authorize on effective permissions rather than role names, cutting Development Environments organization-wide provisioning from 90 minutes to 5 minutes and removing standing admin access for all teams.
- Embedded DevSecOps controls across CI/CD pipelines – SAST, DAST, dependency and container-image scanning, secret detection, and CVE management (SonarQube/SonarCloud, OWASP ZAP, Burp Suite, Trivy, TruffleHog, Defender for Cloud) – shifting security left and gating releases on policy.
- Architected Google Cloud landing zones with the FAST framework (Cloud Foundation Fabric) – YAML-driven, schema-validated project provisioning with dedicated spoke VPCs, PAM just-in-time access, and Org Policy guardrails.
- Engineered GitOps-style CI/CD for GCP infrastructure with Azure Pipelines and Terraform – Workload Identity Federation for keyless authentication and a read-only/read-write service-account split gating plan-on-PR and apply-on-merge.
- Built security-hardened, CIS-aligned golden OS images (Windows Server 2025, Trusted Launch) with Azure Image Builder and Packer, distributed via Azure Compute Gallery to Azure Virtual Desktop, self-hosted DevOps agents, and Trusted Compute Instances, serving thousands of endpoints.
- Engineered deployment observability with Azure Monitor Logs Ingestion (custom Log Analytics tables, data collection rules) for durable, queryable audit trails across ephemeral infrastructure.
- Drove cloud migration of over 20 legacy on-premises applications to Azure-native services (ACI, App Services, AKS), retiring multiple on-prem servers / reducing hosting cost by 70%.

Support Escalation Engineer, Azure IaaS VMs

01/2022 – 05/2024

Microsoft · Bucharest, Romania

- Providing expert guidance to Fortune 500 customers and leveraging internal and public tools to resolve complex technical issues across multiple domains:
 - **Storage** – Azure Storage Accounts, Azure File Shares, Azure Blob Storage and Azure Disk Encryption.
 - **Connectivity** – OS issues on both Linux (Red Hat, SUSE, Ubuntu, and other supported distributions) or Windows, Network issues, etc.
 - **Management** – VM Performance and Migration from on premises to Azure.
 - **Configuration and Setup** – Troubleshooting deployment issues.
- Led troubleshooting of high-severity production cases, including no-boot scenarios, kernel panics, network issues, and misconfigurations, ensuring SLA compliance. Provided best-effort support and guidance on best practices, earning multiple Customer Hero recognitions and consistently high CSAT scores.

- Contributing to my team's success as an Escalation Point for Linux related issues, empowering colleagues and team members to offer the best customer experience through 1:1 sessions of coaching and mentorship.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Automated Enterprise Image Lifecycle Management — pipeline-built, security-hardened golden OS images delivered on a schedule to Dev Box and self-hosted DevOps agents with Azure Image Builder.

Trusted Compute Instances — self-service VM provisioning with zero standing privilege across a 300+ subscription tenant: just-in-time PIM elevation, an ABAC-fenced two-identity model, and capability-based entitlement checks.

GCP FAST Landing Zones — YAML-driven, schema-validated project provisioning on Cloud Foundation Fabric with dedicated spoke VPCs, PAM just-in-time access, and Org Policy guardrails.

Microservices on Kubernetes, Production Hardened — deployed a microservices stack from a private registry with Helm charts and Helmfile, applying production and security best practices.

Terraform-Provisioned CI/CD to EKS — complete Jenkins pipeline provisioning AWS EKS clusters with a shared remote state and deploying from a private ECR/DockerHub registry.

Python Automation Toolkit — Boto3 and Terraform automations for EC2 health checks, EBS volume backup and restore, and website monitoring with self-recovery.

SKILLS

CLOUD PLATFORMS	Microsoft Azure, AWS, DigitalOcean, Google Cloud Platform
AZURE SERVICES	AVD, Azure Image Builder, Dev Box, Azure Container Registry, WebApps, Azure Container Instances, Azure IoT Hub, IoT Central
AWS SERVICES	EC2, EKS, ECR, IAM, VPC, S3
CONTAINERS	Kubernetes (K8s), AKS, EKS, Helm, Docker
INFRASTRUCTURE AS CODE	Terraform, Bicep, ARM Templates, Ansible
CI/CD & ARTIFACTS	Azure DevOps, Jenkins, GitLab, GitHub Actions, Git, Nexus Repository Manager, Docker Hub
SECURITY & IDENTITY	Microsoft Sentinel, Defender for Cloud, Entra ID, Conditional Access Policies, Privileged Identity Management, Intune, Zero Trust, MITRE ATT&CK Framework
AUTOMATION & SCRIPTING	Python, JavaScript, Bash, PowerShell, RPA (UiPath)
MONITORING	Prometheus, Grafana, New Relic
BUILD TOOLS	Gradle, Maven, pip, npm, yarn
OPERATING SYSTEMS	Linux (Ubuntu / RHEL / SUSE), Windows Server

CERTIFICATIONS

Azure DevOps Engineer Expert	Azure Administrator Associate
Azure Solutions Architect	Azure Virtual Desktop
Azure Security Engineer Associate	DevOps Practitioner — TechWorld with Nana
Azure Identity and Access Administrator Associate	DevSecOps Practitioner — TechWorld with Nana

ONGOING DEVELOPMENT

SC-100 — Microsoft Cybersecurity Architect
SAL1 — Security Analyst Level 1, TryHackMe
German — B1 (in progress)

EDUCATION & LANGUAGES

DevOps Bootcamp & DevSecOps Bootcamp	— TechWorld with Nana	2026 - Completed
Bachelor's Degree, Law	— Romanian-American University, Bucharest, Romania	09/2009 – 06/2014
Languages	— English (C2), German (A2)	